



MANAGING CONFLICT | EXERCISE 1

Which Conflict Resolution Style?

Effective conflict resolution is an essential skill in the workplace, enabling collaboration and productive outcomes. Match these scenarios to the conflict resolution style which best fits the situation, find the correct answers in the footer of the next page.

Resolution Styles



COLLABORATING



ACCOMMODATING



COMPROMISING



COMPETING



AVOIDING

Conflict Scenarios

1

You are working with a colleague who is passionate about a topic that isn't important to you. They want you to agree to a change in approach, which whilst not your preference, is workable.

2

You are working on a project and a legal issue arises which relates to employment law and the rights of employees. You are 100% certain that what your colleague is proposing is neither morally nor legally correct.

3

You are upset that you haven't been invited to attend the annual customer golf day. You could complain to the sales leader and see if you can change their mind.

4

You are defining a new service for your client with a colleague and you both have some very strong views on what should be included. The budget won't allow for everything, it's just not possible.

5

The launch of a new product is 2 months away and you need to agree on a plan with the product team. You both have some great ideas as to how to approach it and there are several options on the table.



MANAGING CONFLICT | STYLES AND TIPS

Conflict Resolution

	WHEN TO USE	BEST PRACTICE	RISK
 COMPETING	When you want to 'win.' When you know you are right. Things you are passionate about.	Express your needs clearly & confidently but not aggressively. Avoid emotive language. Highlight benefits to the individual. Be gracious in victory.	Can come across as authoritative and dictatorial. Can cause bad feeling. Can damage relationships.
 ACCOMMODATING	When you are happy for the other person to have their way. When the issue isn't important to you. When the relationship is more important	Point out that even though it may not be your preference, you are willing to agree, in the interests of the relationship. Show that you are thinking of the 'bigger picture.'	Danger that you may be seen as a 'pushover.' Danger that it may set a precedent.
 AVOIDING	Only use when the matter is totally trivial. Where there is no possible resolution. Where it makes sense for someone else to resolve the issue. Where the issue is likely to resolve itself.	Avoid for the right reasons (not because you want to avoid confronting the issue). Come to terms with it quickly.	Unresolved conflict can become toxic, so make 100% sure that you are avoiding for the right reasons.
 COLLABORATING	Appropriate for the resolution of important issues. Enables both parties to get a result they are happy with – 'win/win.'	Define your desired outcome in advance. Express your desire to resolve the issue. Understand their perspective and listen. Present your position. Discuss options & agree a way forward together.	Can be time consuming. Can be wearing for others.
 COMPROMISING	Appropriate for less important issues or where a quick answer is required. Both parties get some of what they want by establishing a 'middle ground.'	Requires good negotiation skills. Set expectations up front so all parties understand they won't be totally satisfied. Accept that it won't be perfect. Try to get the best possible outcome.	Potential risk that neither party walks away feeling satisfied with the outcome.

EXERCISE 1 ANSWERS:

Scenario one=Accommodating / Scenario two=Competing / Scenario three=Avoiding / Scenario four=Compromising / Scenario five=Collaborating